

Lucy H. Butler

Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Psychology of Misinformation Lab
Network Science Institute, Northeastern University (Boston, USA)

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Citizenship: Australian

Primary Research Interests

Applied and basic cognition; Misinformation susceptibility and intervention effectiveness; Epistemically suspect beliefs; Belief formation, maintenance and updating; Memory and memory failure; Social influence (particularly in online environments); Information seeking behavior; Metacognition.

Education

- 2021 – 2024 **Doctor of Philosophy (PhD)**
The University of Western Australia, School of Psychological Science
Thesis: *Beyond the individual: Examining how characteristics of social media information environments impact susceptibility to misinformation and the effectiveness of misinformation interventions*
Primary and Coordinating Supervisor: Prof. Ullrich K. H. Ecker
Co-supervisors: Associate Prof. Nicolas Fay and Dr Briana Kennedy
- 2019 **First Class Honours in Psychology¹**
The University of Western Australia, School of Psychological Science
GPA: 7.0/7.0
Thesis: *The Limited Continued Influence Effect: No Influence of Retracted Event Misinformation on General Attitudes*
Supervisor: Prof. Ullrich K. H. Ecker
- 2016 – 2018 **Bachelor of Science (Double Major in Psychology)**
The University of Western Australia, School of Psychological Science
GPA: 7.0/7.0
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Professional Employment

- 2024 – Present **Postdoctoral Research Fellow**
Psychology of Misinformation Lab, Northeastern University, Boston, MA
Affiliations: Network Science Institute, Department of Psychology, Department of Political Science, Institute for Information, the Internet, and Democracy
Supervisor: Dr. Briony Swire-Thompson
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¹ In Australia, Honours is a one-year degree with a significant research component. It is completed after a bachelor's degree and is a prerequisite for postgraduate studies

Peer Reviewed Publications and Book Chapters (^ Denotes student co-author)

- Butler, L. H., & Swire-Thompson, B.** (2026). Corrections outperform expertise-based interventions for countering misinformation from alternative medicine sources. *Applied Psychology: Health and Well-Being*, 18(2), e70143. <https://doi.org/10.1111/aphw.70143>
- ^Dobbs, M., **Butler, L.H.** & Swire-Thompson, B. (2026) The differential consequences of correcting misinformation for high and low credibility sources. *Scientific Reports*. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41598-026-42329-x>
- Butler, L. H.,** DeGuis, J., Tay, L., Ecker, U. K. H., Swire-Thompson, B. (2025) Corrections are effective for science misinformation. *Nature Human Behaviour*, 1-3, <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41562-025-02245-y>
- Swire-Thompson, B., **Butler, L. H.,** & Rapp, D. N. (2025). The truth sandwich format does not enhance the correction of misinformation. *Journal of Educational Psychology*, 117(6), 851–862. <https://doi.org/10.1037/edu0000961>
- Georgiou, N., Balzan, R., **Butler, L. H.,** Van Antwerpen, N. R., Prike, T. & Delfabbro, P. (2025). Effectiveness of the Scientific Reasoning Intervention on Reducing Online Conspiracy Beliefs and Misinformation Engagement: A Study Using the (Mis)Information Game. *Applied Cognitive Psychology*. 39(4). <https://doi.org/10.1002/acp.70069>.
- Butler, L. H.,** Prike, T., & Ecker, U. K. (2024). Nudge-based misinformation interventions are effective in information environments with low misinformation prevalence. *Scientific Reports*, 14(1), 11495. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41598-024-62286-7>
- Butler, L. H.,** Fay, N., & Ecker, U. K. (2024). Others (dis-) endorse this so it must (not) be true: High relative endorsement increases perceived misinformation veracity but not correction effectiveness. *Applied Cognitive Psychology*, 38(1), e4146. <https://doi.org/10.1002/acp.4146>
- Prike, T., **Butler, L. H.,** & Ecker, U. K. (2024). Source-credibility information and social norms improve truth discernment and reduce engagement with misinformation online. *Scientific Reports*, 14(1), 6900. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41598-024-57560-7>
- Butler, L. H.,** Lamont, P., Wan, D. L. Y., Prike, T., Nasim, M., Walker, B., Fay, N. & Ecker, U. K. H. (2024). The (Mis)Information Game: A Social Media Simulator. *Behavior Research Methods*. 56(3), 2376-2397. <https://doi.org/10.3758/s13428-023-02153-x>
- Butler, L. H.** & Ecker, U. K. H. (2023). Misinformation in Open and Closed Online Platforms: Impacts and Countermeasures. In C. Soon (Ed.) *Mobile Communication and Online Falsehoods: Trends, Impact and Practice* (pp. 279-303). Springer.
- Butler, L. H.,** Fay, N. & Ecker, U. K. H. (2023). Social Endorsement Influences the Continued Belief in Corrected Misinformation. *Journal of Applied Research in Memory and Cognition*. 12(3), 364. <https://doi.org/10.1037/mac0000080>
- Swire-Thompson, B., Cook, J., **Butler, L. H.,** Sanderson, J. A., Lewandowsky, S., & Ecker, U. K. H. (2021). Correction format has a limited role when debunking misinformation. *Cognitive Research: Principles and Implications*, 6(1), 1-15. <https://doi.org/10.1186/s41235-021-00346-6>
- Ecker, U. K. H., **Butler, L. H.,** Cook, J., Hurlstone, M. J., Kurz, T., & Lewandowsky, S. (2020). Using the COVID-19 economic crisis to frame climate change as a secondary issue reduces mitigation support. *Journal of Environmental Psychology*, 70, 101464. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jenvp.2020.101464>
- Ecker, U. K. H., **Butler, L. H.,** & Hamby, A. (2020). You [don't] have to tell a story! A Registered Report testing the effectiveness of narrative versus expository misinformation corrections. *Cognitive Research: Principles and Implications*, 5, 64. <https://doi.org/10.1186/s41235-020-00266-x>

Manuscripts Under Review

- Butler, L. H.**, Gile, C. I., Prike, T., Swire-Thompson, B., Hertwig, R., & Ecker, U. K. H. *Brief summarization improves effectiveness of fact-checks, whereas a mental-imagery-based mnemonic does not.*
- ^Acierno, J., **Butler, L. H.**, Davis, J., Liang, N., Constantino, S. M., & Swire-Thompson B. *The impact of vaccine information seeking in mixed quality environments.*
- Fay, N., Walker, B., Prike, T., Ecker, U. K. H., **Butler, L. H.**, Howe, P.D. L., Ye, M. *How might a dislike option affect how people evaluate and engage with online content?*
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Select Working Papers

- Butler, L. H.**, Ecker, U. K. H., Modirrousta-Galian, A., Highan, P., Bijak, J., Prike, T. *Learning to tell fact from fiction: Testing the effectiveness of exemplar-based training for improving fake news detection*
- Fazio, L. K., Rand, D., Lewandowsky, S., Susmann, M., **Butler, L. H.**, Berinsky, A. J., Guess, A., Kendeou, P., Lyons, B., Miller, J., Newman, E., Pennycook, G., Swire-Thompson, B., Building a Better Toolkit Team (2026). *Combating misinformation: A megastudy of nine interventions designed to reduce the sharing of and belief in false and misleading headlines.*
- Kumar, S., **Butler, L. H.**, DeGutis, J., Amazeen, M. A., & Swire-Thompson, B. *Development and validation of the Misinformation Susceptibility Self-Report (MiSS)*
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Conference Presentations and Posters

- Fazio, L. K., Rand, D., Lewandowsky, S., Susmann, M., **Butler, L. H.**, Berinsky, A. J., Guess, A., Kendeou, P., Lyons, B., Miller, J., Newman, E., Pennycook, G., Swire-Thompson, B., Building a Better Toolkit Team (2026). *Combating misinformation: A megastudy of nine interventions designed to reduce the sharing of and belief in false and misleading headlines.* SPSP Annual Convention, Chicago, Illinois, February 26-28, 2026.
- ^Acierno, J., **Butler, L. H.**, Constantino, S., & Swire-Thompson, B. (December 2025). *Information Seeking Isn't Enough: Source Credibility and Vaccine Attitudes Shape Belief Updates.* 2025 *Directions of Polarization, Social Norms & Trust in Societies' Workshop*, Cambridge, MA.
- Butler, L. H.** & Swire-Thompson, B. (2025) *Corrections outperform expertise-based interventions for countering misinformation from alternative medicine sources.* (poster) 66th Meeting of the Psychonomics Society, Denver, Colorado, USA, November 20-23, 2025.
- ^Dobbs, M., **Butler, L. H.** & Swire-Thompson, B. (2025). *The impact of corrections on belief and source credibility across high and low credibility sources.* (talk) Society for Applied Research in Memory and Cognition 15th Biennial Meeting, Kildare, Ireland, June 11-14, 2025.
- ^Delisle, E., **Butler, L. H.** & Swire-Thompson, B. (2025). *Interventions for Boosting Credibility for Legitimate Health Sources.* (poster) 51st Annual Meeting of the Society for Philosophy & Psychology, Cornell University, Ithaca, NY, June 19-21, 2025.
- Butler, L. H.**, Rapp, D. & Swire-Thompson, B. (2024). *Is the truth sandwich superiority baloney? No evidence for enhanced efficacy for misinformation correction.* (poster) 65th Meeting of the Psychonomics Society, New York City, USA, November 21-24, 2024.
- Prike, T., **Butler, L. H.**, Modirrousta-Galian, A., Higham, P., Bijak, J., Ecker, U. K. H. (2024). *Learning to Tell Fact from Fiction: Exemplar Based Training Improves Discernment of Misinformation But Only for Similar Headlines.* (poster) 65th Meeting of the Psychonomics Society, New York City, USA, November 21-24, 2024.
- Butler, L. H.**, Lamont, P. X., Law Yim Wan, D., Prike, T., Nasim, M., Walker, B., Fay, N., & Ecker, U. K. H. (2022). *The (Mis)Information Game: A social media simulator.* (talk) Western

Australian Psychological Science Conference, University of Western Australia, Australia, December 8, 2023.

Butler, L. H., Lamont, P. X., Law Yim Wan, D., Prike, T., Nasim, M., Walker, B., Fay, N., & Ecker, U. K. H. (2022). The (Mis)Information Game: A social media simulator. (talk) *14th Meeting of the Society for Applied Research in Memory and Cognition, SARMAC XIV*, Nagoya, Japan, August 9-12, 2023.

Prike, T., **Butler, L. H.**, & Ecker, U. K. H. (2023). Source-credibility information and social norms reduce misinformation sharing online. (talk) *14th Meeting of the Society for Applied Research in Memory and Cognition, SARMAC XIV*, Nagoya, Japan, August 9-12, 2023.

Ecker, U. K. H., Lewandowsky, S., Kurz, T., Hurlstone, M. J., **Butler, L. H.**, Cook, J., & Facer, K. (2021). COVID-19 and climate change—Present discourse and future pathways. *Healthy Environments and Living Conference, HEAL 2021*, Canberra, November 17-18.

Butler, L. H., Hamby, A., & Ecker, U. K. H. (2021). You don't have to tell a story! Testing the effectiveness of narrative versus non-narrative misinformation corrections. *Virtual SARMAC 2021*, July 21-23.

Sanderson, J. A., Swire-Thompson, B., Cook, J., **Butler, L. H.**, Lewandowsky, S., & Ecker, U. K. H. (2021). Evidence for a limited role of correction format when debunking misinformation. *Virtual SARMAC 2021*, July 21-23.

Teaching Experience

Supervision and mentorship

2024 – present

Jane Acierno (5th year psychology PhD student; acting primary supervisor November 2024-March 2025)

Mitch Dobbs (4th year psychology PhD student; acting primary supervisor November 2024-March 2025)

2024 – 2026

Sagar Kumar (Network Science PhD, completed August 2026)

2024 – 2025

Emma Delisle (Post-Bacc research assistant; acting primary supervisor November 2024-March 2025)

Lecturing

2026

POLS2396: Psychology of Misinformation (*Northeastern University, 16 students*)
Coordinated and taught a 14-week university course on the psychology of misinformation. This course covers topics related to drivers of susceptibility, influences of misinformation belief, and misinformation intervention effectiveness.

2024 – present

PSYC3466: Cognition (*Northeastern University, ~75 students per semester*)
Why People Believe Misinformation and How to Counter It — Present a semesterly guest lecture on the cognitive and social mechanisms that drive belief in misinformation, and theories underlying individual-level misinformation interventions.

2022

PSYC2212: Psychology and Social Behaviour (*University of Western Australia, ~400 students*)
The Psychology of Social Influence//The Misinformation Problem: Why People Believe (and Continue to Believe) Misinformation — Developed and presented a lecture on theories of social influence and the role of social influence in misinformation susceptibility. Included discussion of interventions to counter

misinformation and the conditions in which they are and are not effective. **Designed and implemented two misinformation/social influence laboratory classes, including developing materials and grading criteria for the main assessment (2022–2023).**

Tutoring/Demonstrating

- 2023 **PSYC2213: Lifespan Development** (*University of Western Australia, ~80 students*)
Delivered four 2-hour tutorials over five weeks on developmental theories (Piaget, Vygotsky), environmental and biological determinants, developmental assessment, and cognitive decline. Instructed students in systematic literature searches and small-scale systematic reviews; assessed written and oral assignments.
- 2022 – 2023 **PSYC2203: Introduction to Quantitative Methods in Psychology** (*University of Western Australia, ~60 students per semester*)
Led three 2-hour tutorials over eight weeks covering research design, correlations, t-tests, ANOVAs, regression, and non-parametric statistics. Trained students in manual and Jamovi-based analyses; assessed data-focused lab reports.
- 2022 **PSYC2212: Psychology and Social Behaviour** (*University of Western Australia, 180 students*)
Facilitated four 2-hour tutorials over five weeks on social psychology topics including social influence, cultural evolution, attitudes, stereotypes, altruism, and group processes.
- 2021 **PSYC1102: Psychology: Behaviour in Context** (*University of Western Australia, 80 students*)
Delivered four 2-hour tutorials over six weeks covering developmental, social, personality, and abnormal psychology. Assessed laboratory reports.
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Service and Engagement

- 2025 **PhD student workshops, (1) How to Peer Review; (2) How to write clearly**
Network Science Institute, Northeastern University
- 2024- **Assisted in Running Misinformation Speaker Series**
Co-run by Harvard Kennedy School and NU Lab at Northeastern University
- 2024 **Panel Chair, Internet Democracy Initiative Conference**
“Auditing of Algorithms and Platforms” *Christo Wilson & Laura Edelson*
Northeastern, London Campus
- 2024 **Contributed Expert Feedback on Australian Government National Science and Technology Council Report on Misinformation Interventions**
- 2023-2024 **PhD student Representative, Engagement and Impact Committee**
School of Psychological Science, University of Western Australia
- 2022-2024 **Co-creator and coordinator, School of Psychological Science reading group**
University of Western Australia
- 2023 **Facilitator, School of Psychological Science Exhibition, Open Day**
University of Western Australia

- 2022-2023 **Facilitator, “You are fake news”: Psychological Science Activity**
Engagement activity for visiting high school students (years 8-12) for the School of Psychological Science, University of Western Australia
- 2020 **Consultant with Youth Affairs Council of Western Australia**
The impact of COVID-19 on regional and rural youth
- 2017-2018 **Unimmentor**
University of Western Australia
- 2017 **Peer-Assisted Learning Facilitator**
PSYC1101: *Psychology Mind and Brain*, University of Western Australia, Albany campus.

Ad-Hoc Manuscript Reviewing

Acta Psychologica, American Journal of Undergraduate Research, Applied Psychology: Health and Well-Being (×2), Cognitive Research: Principles and Implications (×3), Collective Intelligence, Communication Psychology (×2), Journalism, Journal of Applied Research in Memory and Cognition (×3), Personality and Individual Differences (×2), PLOS ONE, PNAS, Political Analysis, Scientific Reports (×2), Self and Identity, Social Media + Society (×2)

Scholarships, Grants and Awards

- 2026 IIID Seed Grant *When Do User Corrections Work? Controlled Evaluation of Corrections Efficacy in Realistic Social Media Settings* (\$3000 USD)
- 2025 APA Editor’s Choice Award (*Swire-Thompson, Butler & Rapp, 2025*)
- 2024 Dean’s List Honourable Mention—Recognition of an Outstanding Doctoral Thesis (awarded to approximately 5% of PhD recipients at the University of Western Australia)
- 2021– 2024 Australian Government Research Training Program Stipend (\$30000 - \$35000 AUD p/a)
- 2023 Psychological Science Postgraduate Student Engagement and Impact Award (University of Western Australia School)
- 2023 Higher degree by research overseas travel award (\$1850 AUD)
- 2017 PSYC2213 Psychology: Lifespan Development Highest Achieving Student
- 2017 UWA Albany Science Scholarship (\$5000 AUD)
Awarded based on academic achievement and enrolment in a Bachelor of Science at UWA Albany Campus.
- 2016 Watkin’s Family Prize (\$1000 AUD)
Awarded to the UWA Albany first year student with the highest average mark across the four units they achieved their highest marks.
- 2016 Clive Malcolm Memorial Sustainability Scholarship (\$2500 AUD)
Awarded based on academic achievement and enrolment at the UWA Albany campus

Technical Skills

Statistical and Data Analysis

- Proficient in R (tidyverse, ggplot2, R Markdown); experienced in advanced frequentist and Bayesian statistical analysis; skilled in data wrangling, visualisation, and reproducible reporting.

Computational Methods

- JavaScript, Firebase, HTML/CSS, Git/GitHub
- Developed and maintained complex data pipelines and backend infrastructure for large-scale online research platforms.

Experimental Methods

- Qualtrics, jsPsych
 - Experienced designing and deploying online experiments for large-scale participant samples; developed custom stimuli, assessment instruments.
 - Co-creator of *The Misinformation Game*, an open-source platform enabling researchers with limited coding experience to run fully customisable social media experiments; supports text, image, and engagement metadata-rich stimuli.
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Media examples

How to talk to your ‘skeptic’ family about science misinformation. *Popular Science*.
<https://www.popsci.com/health/how-to-talk-about-science-misinformation/>

Misinformation is easy to ignore online, but what to do when it permeates the festive family lunch?
The Monthly <https://www.themonthly.com.au/blog/santilla-chingaipe/2024/19/2024/christmas-crackers>

References (additional references available upon request)

Assistant Professor Briony Swire-Thompson

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Professor Ullrich Ecker

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